

Composite Figure Area Rescue

Unit 5: Architecture Firm • Lesson 5-5 • EduWonderLab

UNIT 5 • LESSON 5-5 • TEACHER NOTES

Standard 6.G.1

FORMAT Floor-plan rescue task cards

TIME 25–35 min

GROUPING Pairs

TOPIC Area of Composite Figures

STANDARD 6.G.1

PREP LEVEL Light — print composite figure cards and area organizer

Learning goal *I can find the area of a composite figure by decomposing or subtracting shapes.*

Teacher setup

- Print one card set and organizer per pair. Each card is a floor plan made of simpler shapes.
- Students label each part, find partial areas, and add or subtract for the total.
- Color-code the parts to keep them organized.

Materials

Composite figure cards, Colored pencils, Area organizer, Pencil.

Differentiation & language support

- Area organizer lists each part and its area (SPED).
- Sentence stem: “I decomposed the figure by ____ because ____.”
- ESOL: label each shape with its name (rectangle, triangle, square).

Key vocabulary (English / Español):

Term	Español	What it means
composite figure	figura compuesta	a shape made of simpler shapes
decompose	descomponer	to break into smaller shapes

Quick teacher check: *Ask a pair to show the subtraction method on Card 2.*

Composite Figure Area Rescue

Unit 5: Architecture Firm · Lesson 5-5 · EduWonderLab

Name: _____ Date: _____ Class: _____

Your goal: *I can find the area of a composite figure by decomposing or subtracting shapes.*

What you need

Composite figure cards, Colored pencils, Area organizer.

How to play

1. Pick a floor-plan card and split it into simpler shapes.
2. Find the area of each part.
3. Add the parts (or subtract a missing piece).
4. Record the total area with square units.

Floor-Plan Cards

Break each figure into rectangles, squares, or triangles. Add or subtract to find the total area.

1. A rectangle 8×5 with a 3×3 square added on. Total area?	2. A 10×6 rectangle with a 2×3 corner removed. Area?
3. An L-shape: a 6×4 rectangle plus a 4×2 rectangle. Area?	4. A 12×8 rectangle with a 4×5 rectangle cut out. Area?
5. A 10×4 rectangle with a triangle (base 10, height 3) on top. Area?	6. A 6×6 square with a triangle (base 6, height 4) removed. Area?
7. Two rectangles: 5×3 and 7×2 . Total area?	8. A 9×6 rectangle with a triangle (base 9, height 4) on top. Area?

Area organizer (each part + total):

Explain your thinking

Explain when you would add areas and when you would subtract to find a composite area.

Sentence frame: *I decomposed the figure by ___ because ___.*

★ **Challenge:** *Card 4 used subtraction. Solve it again by decomposing into rectangles that you add. Do you get 76?*

ANSWER KEY

Teacher copy — please do not distribute to students.

UNIT 5 • LESSON 5-5 • Composite Figure Area Rescue

Standard 6.G.1

Answers

1. A rectangle 8×5 with a 3×3 square added on. Total area? Answer: 49 sq units ($40 + 9$)	2. A 10×6 rectangle with a 2×3 corner removed. Area? Answer: 54 sq units ($60 - 6$)
3. An L-shape: a 6×4 rectangle plus a 4×2 rectangle. Area? Answer: 32 sq units ($24 + 8$)	4. A 12×8 rectangle with a 4×5 rectangle cut out. Area? Answer: 76 sq units ($96 - 20$)
5. A 10×4 rectangle with a triangle (base 10, height 3) on top. Area? Answer: 55 sq units ($40 + 15$)	6. A 6×6 square with a triangle (base 6, height 4) removed. Area? Answer: 24 sq units ($36 - 12$)
7. Two rectangles: 5×3 and 7×2 . Total area? Answer: 29 sq units ($15 + 14$)	8. A 9×6 rectangle with a triangle (base 9, height 4) on top. Area? Answer: 72 sq units ($54 + 18$)

Teaching notes & look-fors

- Add when shapes combine; subtract when a piece is removed.
- Card 4 can be solved by addition or subtraction — both give 76 sq units.